

European gas prices to stay elevated

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【メール原文】

European gas prices will stay higher than Eurasia Group initially forecast for this winter. Dutch TTF prices, currently trading in the €70-€85 range, |||||

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Title Transfer Facility (TTF) prices will keep trading above Eurasia Group's original €45-€65 winter forecast, driven by low inventories and Qatari supply disruptions.

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Mild winter forecasts across Europe and Northeast Asia will keep the risk of outright gas shortages low this season (65% odds).

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EU gas inventories will enter spring 2027 at low levels, straining Europe's ability to restock before the next heating season.

European gas prices will stay higher than Eurasia Group initially forecast for this winter. Dutch TTF prices, currently trading in the €70-€85 range, have already exceeded the €45-€65 range Eurasia Group expected in August (see: EU will likely scrape through winter on tighter gas reserves , 13 August 2026). Low inventory levels and ongoing supply disruptions from the Middle East, particularly Qatar, will keep prices elevated through the season.

Mild winter forecasts across Europe and Northeast Asia will stem the risk of outright shortages. Eurasia Group maintains its previous forecast that stocks are 65% likely to be sufficient to meet demand, unless the region experiences an unusually long and cold winter. Weather models show a more than 70% probability of warmer-than-average winters across most of Europe and Northeast Asia, including Japan, South Korea, and the east coast of China.

Average EU gas inventories will fall just short of 80% by the official start of winter on 1 November. The remaining injections will depend mostly on purchases by state-controlled entities, particularly in the Netherlands and Germany. Many commercial buyers have avoided winter storage purchases this summer because winter prices have sat slightly below spot prices, making storage unprofitable.

Structural factors will keep prices elevated throughout the winter despite the low risk of physical shortages:

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The Middle East standoff has escalated and is now likely to persist through the end of 2026 (see: Standoff now likely to run through 2026 as Hormuz traffic increases , 1 September 2026), delaying the

return of Qatari LNG;

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Asian buyers, competing with Europe for the same US cargoes amid the Qatari outage, have pushed the TTF and Asia's Japan Korea Marker (JKM) benchmark into close correlation;

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The TTF tracks conditions in Northwest Europe specifically, where the densely populated, industrialized Netherlands, Belgium, and Germany face high demand and below-average inventories. The UK's National Balancing Point (NBP) also influences the TTF through pipeline connections;

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And government-ordered storage purchases, as in 2022, have drawn speculative traders betting on further price increases. The Dutch government ordered purchases in June, and reports suggest Berlin pressured (though did not order) state-owned utilities to do the same.

EU gas inventories will enter spring 2027 at low levels. A likely mild winter will temper depletion, but heating demand and the EU's ban on Russian LNG imports starting in January will still drain stocks. US and other Atlantic basin cargoes should cover much of the shortfall from the ban, but Europe's ability to restock next year amid continued market and geopolitical disruption will determine its readiness for the next heating season.

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